

SOURCE ONE

Whenever he heard that Philip had captured some famous city or won an overwhelming victory, Alexander would take no pleasure at the news, but would declare to his companions 'Boys, my father will leave nothing great or spectacular for you and me to accomplish to show the world'. He cared nothing for pleasure or wealth but only for deeds of valour and glory'.

Plutarch - *Life of Alexander*, 5.

SOURCE TWO

He burnt the palace of the Persian kings [Persepolis], though this was against the advice of Parmenio...

Alexander's answer was that he wished to punish the Persians for their invasion of Greece; his present act was retribution for the destruction of Athens, the burning of temples, and all of the other crimes they had committed against the Greeks.

Arrian, *The Campaigns of Alexander*, 3.19.

SOURCE THREE

Your ancestors invaded Macedonia and Greece...

You sent aid to the people of Perinthus in their rebellion against my father; Ochus sent an army into Thrace, which was part of our dominions; my father was killed by assassins whom, as you openly boasted in your letters, you yourself hired to commit the crime... you unjustly and illegally seized the throne... you sent Greeks false information about me in the hope of you making them my enemies; you attempt to supply the Greeks with money... your agents corrupted my friends... it was you [Darius] who began this quarrel.

Arrian, *The Campaigns of Alexander*, 2.14, a supposed letter to Darius.

SOURCE FOUR

On one occasion, some Persian ambassadors arrived in Macedonia while Philip was away. Alexander received them. He talked to them and questioned them on matters such as the distances they had travelled by road, the nature of the country, the character of the Persian king, his experience in war, the military strength and prowess of the Persians. The ambassadors came away convinced that Philip's celebrated astuteness was as nothing compared to the adventurous spirit and lofty ambitions of his son.

Plutarch, *Life of Alexander*, 5.